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HORISTICS

Definitionernes afslørende kraft

Grammatik · Paragrammatik · Politik · Livskvalitet · Fortolkende nyheder

Hvad grammatik er – ikke hvad den består af

Grammatik *er frembringelse af tanke.* **(def-1)**

[1] Med andre ord er det grammatikken, der frembringer tankerne.

[2] Det lyder enkelt, men det siger, hvad grammatik er, ikke hvad den består af. Det, der gælder for definitioner af grammatik, er i virkeligheden beskrivelser, ikke definitioner.

Tanker *er mentale, sammensatte, simulerede repræsentationer af hændelser.* **(def-2)**

[3] Grammatikken frembringer tanker gennem seks grundlæggende begreber: ordklasser, modi, diateser, aspekter, sætninger og syntaks. Alt andet (morfologi, ordforråd, tegnsætning, udtale og så videre) er paragrammatik.

[4] Når vi tænker på noget, sættes alle seks begreber i gang. Ingen tanke er mulig uden alle seks.

[5] Den menneskelige hjerne er indrettet til at frembringe tanke på nøjagtig samme måde, uanset sprog. Grammatik er derfor et almenmenneskeligt træk, der forener os alle på en helt særlig, men overset måde. Grammatik er universel; sprog er ikke.

Fortsættes på side 2 →

Loven vs. straffen for at bryde loven

At håndhæve straffen for at bryde loven er ikke selve loven.

[20] Hvad er retfærdighed? Lad os definere den:

Retfærdighed *er forebyggelse af kriminalitet.*

[21] Når en forbrydelse først er begået, kan der ikke ske retfærdighed, fordi retfærdighed er at forebygge kriminalitet. Det, der følger – anholdelse, retssag, fængsling – har med straffen for at bryde loven at gøre, og det er ikke retfærdighed. Det, der kaldes retshåndhævelse, er altså i virkeligheden strafhåndhævelse.

[22] Dette afslører meget om definitionernes afslørende kraft, og det, den afslører, er centralt for et utal af misforståelser, der afsporer millioner af menneskers liv.

[23] Tænk på den vending, vi hører i nyhederne efter hver dom: »Retfærdigheden er sket fyldest.« Det er den ikke. Der er sket straf. Den retfærdighed, der kunne være sket, var forebyggelsen af forbrydelsen, og det øjeblik var forbi, før forbrydelsen fandt sted. Det, der er tilbage bagefter, er en konsekvens, ikke en afhjælpning.

[24] Tænk på offeret. Vi fortæller offeret, at

Fortsættes på side 2 →

Hvad grammatik er – ikke hvad den består af

Fortsat fra side 1

Kommunikation *er udveksling af budskaber, der bærer mening.* **(def-3)**

[6] Ethvert budskab, der bærer mening, bærer tanke, og ingen tanke findes uden grammatik. Al kommunikation er derfor grammatisk.

[7] Det siges ofte, at sproget er det, der giver tankerne en stemme, men det er en metafor, ikke en definition.

Sprog *er paragrammatisk kommunikation.* **(def-4)**

[8] Med andre ord er sprog kommunikation gennem paragrammatik. Al kommunikation er grammatisk, men kun sprog er både grammatisk og paragrammatisk. Grammatik er det, alle sprog deler med al tanke; paragrammatik er den dragt, hvert sprog giver den.

[9] Tag en enkel sætning: **Vi købte fisk i morges.** Sig den på engelsk, græsk, spansk eller et hvilket som helst andet sprog, og ordene ændrer sig, endelserne ændrer sig, ordstillingen kan ændre sig. Men grammatikken gør ikke.

Ordklasser

[10] **Vi** er et pronomen, **købte** er et verbum, **fisk** er et substantiv, **i** er en præposition, og **morges** er et substantiv.

[11] Mange ord kan tilhøre forskellige ordklasser i forskellige sammenhænge, men i en given sammenhæng tilhører hvert ord kun én. Taget ét for ét tilhører deres modsvarigheder de samme ordklasser på alle sprog.

[12] På græsk eller spansk kan **vi** udtrykkes (εμείς, *nosotros/as*) eller overlades til verbets endelse. Pronomenet er der under alle omstændigheder. Kun dets markering er forskellig, og det er paragrammatik.

Modus

[13] Sætningen fremsætter et faktum. Den står i indikativ – på alle sprog.

Diatese

[14] Subjektet udfører handlingen: det var os, der købte. Sætningen er aktiv – på alle sprog.

Aspekt

[15] Købet ses som én afsluttet handling. Aspektet er synoptisk – på alle sprog.

Sætning

[16] Det er en fremsættende hovedsætning – på alle sprog.

Syntaks

[17] **Vi** er subjekt, **købte** er verbum, **fisk** er direkte objekt, og **i morges** er adverbium – på alle sprog.

[18] Seks begreber, og ikke ét af dem ændrer sig på tværs af sprog. Det, der varierer *fra sprog til sprog*, er, hvordan hvert sprog markerer dem: dets endelser, dets ordstilling, dets stavemåde, dets udtale og så videre. Det er paragrammatik.

[19] *I næste udgave: ordklasserne, gennemgået i detaljer.*

Loven vs. straffen for at bryde loven

Fortsat fra side 1

der vil ske retfærdighed, at dommen vil bringe retfærdighed. Men skaden er allerede sket, og ingen dom gør den ugjort. Offeret bliver lovet én ting og får en

anden. Mange venter i årevis på en retssag i håb om lettelse, og når dommen falder, føler de sig underligt tomme. De tog ikke fejl i at føle det. De fik det forkerte ord.

[25] Retfærdighed forveksles med straf, med hævn, med økonomisk erstatning og med det lovlige. Den er ingen af dem. Straf er den sanktion, der pålægges efter forbrydelsen. Hævn er skade gengældt med skade. Erstatning er penge betalt for skade, der allerede er sket. Det lovlige er det, loven tillader eller forbyder, og det er ikke usædvanligt, at det lovlige er uretfærdigt, og at det retfærdige er ulovligt. Opioider blev lovligt markedsført og ordineret i massivt omfang, og en afhængighedsepidemi fulgte. I mange lande straffes mennesker for at ytre sig frit. Alle fire kommer efter forbrydelsen eller står ved siden af den. Ingen af dem forebygger den, og derfor er ingen af dem retfærdighed.

[26] Tænk på politikeren. Når politikere lover at slå hårdt ned på kriminalitet, mener de næsten altid hårdere straffe: længere domme, flere fængsler, mere politi efter gerningen. Hver af disse handler først, efter at en forbrydelse er begået. Ifølge definitionen er ingen af dem retfærdighed. En regering, der bruger det meste af sin indsats på straffe, er ikke en regering, der skaber retfærdighed. Den forvalter retfærdighedens fiasko.

[27] Hvis retfærdighed er forebyggelse af kriminalitet, betyder retfærdighed at fjerne de årsager, der får nogen til at begå en forbrydelse, så borgerne slet ikke har nogen grund til at begå forbrydelser. Bag enhver forbrydelse ligger der en årsag, hvad enten det er nød, uvidenhed, udstødelse eller fortvivlelse. Fjern årsagen, og forbrydelsen har intet at vokse af.

[28] Det er først og fremmest politikkens pligt, når politik defineres korrekt. Ikke domstolenes, som kommer for sent. Ikke politiets, som kommer efter opkaldet. Ikke fængslernes, som rummer konsekvenserne af en fiasko, der allerede er sket. Politik er den eneste institution, der står før forbrydelsen, der hvor årsagerne til den formes, og derfor er den den eneste, der overhovedet kan skabe retfærdighed.

[29] Én definition, præcist formuleret, flytter retfærdigheden fra retssalen til klasseværelset, fra fængslet til hjemmet, fra slutningen af historien til dens begyndelse. Det er definitionernes afslørende kraft. Et samfund, der forveksler straf med retfærdighed, vil blive ved med at bygge fængsler og undre sig over, hvorfor kriminaliteten ikke forsvinder. Et samfund, der definerer retfærdighed korrekt, vil stille et andet spørgsmål: ikke hvordan man straffer, men hvordan man forebygger.

FORTOLKENDE NYHEDER

Brugen af atomvåben er ikke længere utænkelig

Theodor Herzl var visionæren bag Stor-Israel

[30] Theodor Herzl (1860–1904) var en østrig-ungarsk jødisk journalist, forfatter og politisk aktivist, som blev den centrale grundlægger af den moderne politiske zionisme.

THEODOR HERZL

Født: Budapest, 2. maj 1860

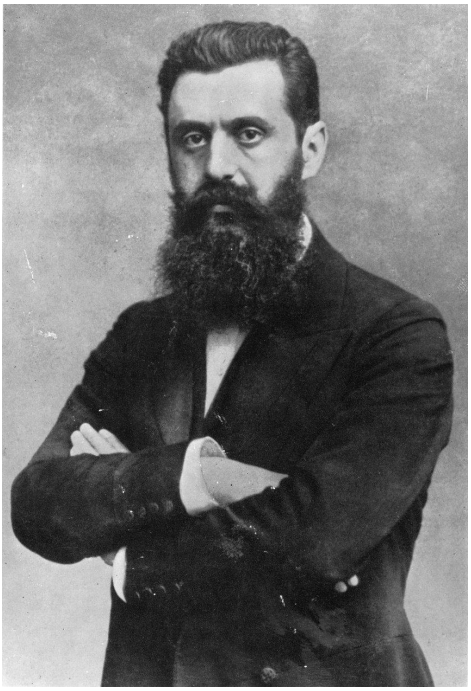
Død: Edlach, Østrig, 3. juli 1904 (begravet i Wien)

Erhverv: journalist, dramatiker, forfatter

Hovedværk: *Der Judenstaat* (Jødestaten), 1896

Politisk rolle: organiserede den første zionistiske kongres i Basel i 1897 og blev præsident for den nyoprettede Zionistiske Organisation.

Mål: et offentligt og retligt sikret hjemland for det jødiske folk.



Theodor Herzl

[31] Han søgte international diplomatisk støtte til projektet, herunder gennem forhandlinger med Det Osmanniske Rige og den britiske regering.

[32] Herzl døde årtier før oprettelsen af staten Israel i 1948 og deltog derfor ikke i selve statens tilblivelse. Hans skrifter og politiske organisation blev ikke desto mindre grundlæggende for den zionistiske bevægelse.

[33] For at slå tonen an, lad os gå tilbage til London i oktober 1902. Den 23. oktober trådte Herzl ifølge sin egen dagbog ind på kontoret hos Joseph Chamberlain, Storbritanniens kolonisekretær, kvart over tolv. Han kom med en anmodning: et territorium under britisk kontrol til jødisk kolonisering. Han nævnte tre steder: Cypern, El-Arish og Sinaihalvøen.

[34] Der findes intet referat af mødet. Det, der er bevaret, er Herzls egen beretning, skrevet i hans dagbog dagen efter. Den er primærkilden, og den er afslørende netop fordi den er hans.

[35] Herzl forklarede, hvorfor han ikke bare kunne vente på sine forhandlinger med den osmanniske sultan, som herskede over Palæstina. Han sammenlignede dem med at købe et tæppe: »Hvis man vil købe et tæppe, må man først drikke et halvt dusin kopper kaffe og ryge hundrede cigaretter; så taler man om familiehistorier, og en gang imellem siger man igen et par ord om tæppet. Jeg har tid til at forhandle, men det har mit folk ikke. De sulter i bosættelsesområdet. Jeg må bringe dem øjeblikkelig hjælp.«

[36] Chamberlain svarede, at han kun kunne udtale sig med myndighed om Cypern, fordi

El-Arish og Sinai hørte under udenrigsministeriet. Om Cypern gengiver Herzl hans svar:

»Cypern er beboet af grækere og muslimer. Jeg kunne ikke fortrænge dem for nye indvandreres skyld. Tværtimod ville det være min pligt at tage deres parti.«

[37] Chamberlain tilføjede derefter, at hvis Herzl kunne pege på et sted i Storbritanniens besiddelser, hvor der ikke boede hvide, ville han være villig til at drøfte det.

[38] Herzl slap ikke Cypern. Han foreslog at skabe en strømning til fordel for jødisk bosættelse på øen, drevet af jødisk kapital. Med hans egne ord:

»Når vi først opretter Det Jødiske Østlige Kompagni med 5 millioner pund i kapital til bosættelse af Sinai og El-Arish, vil cyprioterne også begynde at ønske den gyldne regn over deres ø. Muslimerne vil flytte væk, grækerne vil gerne sælge deres jord til en god pris og udvandre til Athen eller Kreta.«

[39] Og Herzl noterer straks Chamberlains reaktion: »Han syntes at tage godt imod idéen.«

[40] Rækkefølgen er vigtig. Chamberlain nægtede at fortrænge Cyperns grækere og muslimer. Herzl svarede med en plan, hvorefter de ville forlade øen af sig selv: muslimerne ville flytte væk, grækerne ville sælge og udvandre. Og ifølge Herzls beretning syntes Chamberlain at tage godt imod den. Dette er ikke en senere fortolkning af Herzls holdning. Det står i hans egen dagbog, skrevet under hans forhandlinger i London i oktober 1902.

[41] Dagen efter sørgede Chamberlain for, at Herzl kunne mødes med udenrigsminister Lord Lansdowne. Men han bad Herzl holde Cypern uden for det møde: »Den del af planen, der vedrører Cypern, er min sag.«

[42] Dermed lukkede Cypern-muligheden. Storbritannien undersøgte El-Arish, men den plan strandede på den egyptiske regerings holdning og mangel på vand. I 1903 tilbød Chamberlain noget helt andet: et territorium i Britisk Østafrika, den såkaldte Uganda-plan.

[43] Mange hævder, at angrebet den 7. oktober 2023 blev tilladt at finde sted, så Netanyahu-regeringen kunne bruge det til at retfærdiggøre fordrivelsen af palæstinensere fra Gaza. Dette genlyder et aspekt af Theodor Herzls tænkning: da han drøftede Cypern med Joseph Chamberlain i 1902, forestillede Herzl sig, at den muslimske befolkning ville rejse, og at den græske befolkning ville sælge og udvandre til Athen eller Kreta.

[44] Israel fører nu en politik, der sigter mod at ændre det iranske regime. Givet Irans størrelse, befolkning, geografi, militære kapacitet og dokumenterede modstandskraft er det dog langt fra sikkert, at Iran ville kapitulere alene gennem konventionelle militære

operationer. Konflikten har allerede vist Irans evne til at absorbere betydeligt militært pres og samtidig fortsætte med at gengælde.

[45] Alligevel kan hverken Israel eller USA let opgive målet. Begge har investeret massivt i regimeskifte, og at opgive det ville betyde et alvorligt prestigetab og et hårdt psykologisk slag for dem begge.

[46] Samtidig foreligger der rapporter om et stigende israelsk engagement på Cypern, herunder israelske investeringer og sikkerhedssamarbejde. Hvis den israelske regering på et tidspunkt konkluderer, at militært pres ikke vil føre til regimeskifte i Iran, opstår et farligt spørgsmål: Ville den eskalere til brug af taktiske atomvåben? Et sådant skridt ville ikke nødvendigvis garantere den iranske stats sammenbrud og kunne i stedet udløse en ukontrollabel eskalering.

[47] Konsekvenserne kunne række langt ud over Mellemøsten. Et israelsk atomangreb kunne skabe pres på andre atommagter, herunder Rusland og Kina, for at gribe ind eller svare militært. Om de faktisk ville bruge atomvåben, kan ikke forudsiges, men muligheden ville gøre en sådan eskalering til en trussel mod hele det internationale samfund.

[48] Donald Trumps trussel ved FN's Generalforsamling den 22. september 2026, da han spurgte, om han skulle »udslette Den Islamiske Republik«, hvis der ikke blev indgået en fredsaftale, viser, hvor ekstrem den nuværende retorik er blevet. Muligheden for yderligere eskalering vedrører derfor ikke blot Israel, Iran eller Mellemøsten, men potentielt hele menneskeheden.

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[74] The next day, Chamberlain arranged for Herzl to see the Foreign Secretary, Lord Lansdowne. But he told Herzl to leave Cyprus out of that meeting: "The part of the Plan relating to Cyprus is my business."

[75] The Cyprus option closed there. Britain looked into El-Arish, but that plan failed over the Egyptian government's position and the lack of water. In 1903, Chamberlain offered something else entirely: territory in British East Africa, the so-called Uganda Scheme.

[76] Many allege that the October 7, 2023 attack was allowed to happen so that the Netanyahu government could use it to justify the displacement of Palestinians from Gaza. This echoes an aspect of Theodor Herzl's thinking: when discussing Cyprus with Joseph Chamberlain in 1902, Herzl envisaged the departure of the Muslim population and the sale and migration of the Greek population to Athens or Crete.

[77] Israel is now pursuing a policy aimed at changing the Iranian regime. Given Iran's size, population, geography, military capabilities and demonstrated resilience, however, it is far from certain that Iran would capitulate through conventional military operations alone. The conflict has already demonstrated Iran's capacity to absorb substantial military pressure while continuing to retaliate.

[78] Yet neither Israel nor the United States can easily abandon the goal. Both have invested heavily in regime change, and giving it up would mean a serious loss of face and a heavy psychological blow to both.

[79] Meanwhile, there are reports of increasing Israeli involvement with Cyprus, including Israeli investment and security cooperation. If the Israeli government eventually concludes that military pressure will not produce regime change in Iran, a dangerous question arises: would it escalate to the use of tactical nuclear weapons? Such a step would not necessarily guarantee the collapse of the Iranian state and could instead produce an uncontrollable escalation.

[80] The consequences could extend far beyond the Middle East. A nuclear attack by Israel could create pressure for other nuclear powers, including Russia and China, to intervene or respond militarily. Whether they would actually use nuclear weapons cannot be predicted, but the possibility would make such an escalation a threat to the entire international community.

[81] Donald Trump's threat at the UN General Assembly on 22 September 2026, when he asked whether he should "annihilate the Islamic Republic" if no peace deal is reached, demonstrates how extreme the current rhetoric has become. The possibility of further escalation therefore concerns not merely Israel, Iran or the Middle East, but potentially humanity as a whole.

66 To set the tone, let us go back to London in October 1902. On 23 October, according to his own diary, Herzl entered the office of Joseph Chamberlain, Britain's Colonial Secretary, at a quarter past twelve. He came with a request: territory under British control for Jewish colonization. He named three places: Cyprus, El-Arish and the Sinai Peninsula.

67 No transcript of the meeting exists. What survives is Herzl's own account, written in his diary the following day. It is the primary source, and it is revealing precisely because it is his.

68 Herzl explained why he could not simply wait for his negotiations with the Ottoman Sultan, who ruled Palestine. He compared them to buying a carpet: "If you want to buy a carpet, first you must drink half a dozen cups of coffee and smoke a hundred cigarettes; then you discuss family stories, and from time to time you speak again a few words about the carpet. Now I have time to negotiate, but my people has not. They are starving in the Pale. I must bring them immediate help."

69 Chamberlain replied that he could speak with authority only about Cyprus, because El-Arish and Sinai fell under the Foreign Office. On Cyprus, Herzl records his answer:

> *"Cyprus is inhabited by Greeks and Moslems. I could not crowd them out for the sake of new immigrants. On the contrary, it would be my duty to take their side."*

70 Chamberlain then added that if Herzl could point to a place in Britain's possessions where there were no white inhabitants, he would be willing to discuss it.

71 Herzl did not let Cyprus go. He proposed creating a current in favour of Jewish settlement on the island, driven by Jewish capital. In his own words:

> *"Once we establish the Jewish Eastern Company, with 5 million pounds capital, for settling Sinai and El Arish, the Cypriots will begin to want that golden rain on their island, too. The Moslems will move away, the Greeks will gladly sell their lands at a good price and migrate to Athens or Crete."*

72 And Herzl immediately records Chamberlain's reaction: "He seemed to take to the idea."

73 The sequence matters. Chamberlain refused to crowd out the Greeks and Muslims of Cyprus. Herzl answered with a plan by which they would leave on their own: the Muslims would move away, the Greeks would sell and emigrate. And by Herzl's account, Chamberlain seemed to take to it. This is not a later interpretation of Herzl's position. It is in his own diary, written during his London negotiations of October 1902.

[62] One definition, stated precisely, moves justice from the courtroom to the classroom, from the prison to the home, from the end of the story to its beginning. That is the revealing power of definitions. A society that confuses penalty with justice will keep building prisons and wondering why crime does not go away. A society that defines justice correctly will ask a different question: not how to punish, but how to prevent.

INTERPRETIVE NEWS

The Use Of Nuclear Weapons Is No Longer Unthinkable

Theodor Herzl was the visionary of Greater Israel

[63] Theodor Herzl (1860–1904) was an Austro-Hungarian Jewish journalist, writer and political activist who became the central founder of modern political Zionism.

THEODOR HERZL

Born: Budapest, 2 May 1860

Died: Edlach, Austria, 3 July 1904 (buried in Vienna)

Profession: journalist, playwright, writer

Major work: *Der Judenstaat* (The Jewish State), 1896

Political role: organized the First Zionist Congress in Basel in 1897 and became president of the newly established Zionist Organization.

Objective: a publicly and legally secured homeland for the Jewish people.



Theodor Herzl

[64] He pursued international diplomatic support for this project, including negotiations with the Ottoman Empire and the British government.

[65] Herzl died decades before the establishment of the State of Israel in 1948, so he did not take part in the creation of the state itself. His writings and political organization nevertheless became foundational to the Zionist movement.

exclamations.

FOUR EXAMPLES

1. ***Phew, it's finally over!*** The word ***phew*** has no syntactic role: it is not a subject, a complement, an object or anything else. This holds for all interjections.

2. ***Ah, how I miss my mother!***

3. ***Ouch, what happened to me!***

4. ***Bravo, you did it perfectly!***

[51] A handful of words fit none of the definitions of the ten parts of speech. We call those words particles.

[52] *In the next edition: the moods, discussed in detail.*

The Law vs The Penalty For Breaking The Law

Continued from page 1

given another. Many wait years for a trial expecting relief, and when the sentence comes, they feel strangely empty. They were not wrong to feel it. They were given the wrong word.

[58] Justice is confused with punishment, with revenge, with financial compensation and with the legal. It is none of them. Punishment is the penalty imposed after the crime. Revenge is harm returned for harm. Compensation is money paid for damage already done. The legal is what the law permits or forbids, and it is not uncommon for the legal to be unjust and for the just to be illegal. Opioids were legally marketed and prescribed on a mass scale, and an epidemic of addiction followed. In many countries, people are penalized for speaking freely. All four come after the crime or stand beside it. Not one of them prevents it, and so not one of them is justice.

[59] Consider the politician. When politicians promise to be tough on crime, they nearly always mean tough on penalty: longer sentences, more prisons, more police after the fact. Each of these acts only after a crime has been committed. By the definition, none of them is justice. A government that spends most of its effort on penalties is not a government that does justice. It is a government that manages the failure of justice.

[60] If justice is the prevention of crime, then justice means eliminating the reasons that lead anyone to commit a crime, so that citizens have no reason to commit crimes in the first place. Every crime has a reason behind it, whether need, ignorance, exclusion or despair. Remove the reason, and the crime has nothing to grow from.

[61] That is primarily the duty of politics, as politics is properly defined. Not the courts, which arrive too late. Not the police, who arrive after the call. Not the prisons, which hold the consequences of a failure that has already happened. Politics is the only institution placed before the crime, where the reasons for it are formed, and so it is the only one that can do justice at all.

THREE EXAMPLES

1. ***drama*** → noun; ***a lot of drama*** → noun phrase. ***If a film has a lot of drama, it is usually tiring.*** *A lot of drama* is the direct object of the verb *has*.

2. ***story*** → noun; ***a long story*** → noun phrase. ***Her life is a long story.*** *A long story* is the complement of the verb *is*.

3. ***moments*** → noun; ***the hard moments*** → noun phrase. ***The hard moments forge character.*** *The hard moments* is the subject of the verb *forge*.

Conjunctions *are words or groups of words that establish a relation of subordination, that is, of interdependence, between clauses.* **(def-16)**

[44] All conjunctions are hypotactic. The notion that some conjunctions are paratactic is unfounded and will be dealt with **in due time**.

[45] Conventional grammar books divide conjunctions into two categories: coordinating and subordinating. But why is this division made, and what does it contribute to the understanding of grammar?

[46] Conjunctions are divided in this way because the so-called grammarians have not grasped that, with the exception of conditional clauses, if we remove the conjunction from any subordinate clause, it automatically becomes a main clause. This happens not only with the "coordinating" conjunctions, but with all conjunctions.

REMOVE THE CONJUNCTION

1. ***I stayed at home because it was raining.*** Without ***because***: *It was raining.* A main clause.

2. ***I stayed at home, but she went out.*** Without ***but***: *She went out.* A main clause.

[47] As a rule, what makes a clause subordinate is the presence of a conjunction. The story does not end there, however. As we will see, even clauses without any conjunction are sometimes subordinate, because the semantics itself requires it.

[48] The nominal authors of grammar books simply copy other grammar books and paste the copy into a "new" book, changing only a few superficial details to keep up appearances. It goes without saying that the only thing this division of conjunctions contributes to grammar is abundant and pervasive confusion.

[49] It is also very important to point out that the definitions of concepts in these books, when they are given at all, do not meet the requirements of horistics. Beyond that, the "authors" of these books repeatedly violate the very definitions they supposedly formulated. The truth is that they simply copy from other books whatever definition happens to catch their eye.

Interjections *are words or groups of words that express emotion and have no syntactic role.* **(def-17)**

[50] By emotion we also mean **will** (***shh!*** meaning silence, ***come on!***), **hesitation** (***hm***, ***er***) and **social convention** (***hello***, ***thank you***), when these words are used as

verbs. (def-11)

[37] On its own, ***bought*** is only a meaning: an act of buying, by no one in particular. In ***We bought fish***, the subject ***we*** instantiates that meaning: the buying becomes an act that someone actually performed.

Participles *are derivatives of verbs that introduce retrievable elliptical clauses.* (def-12)

[38] A participle stands for a whole clause that has been shortened. The clause can always be retrieved:

[39] ***Having injured his knee, he limped home.*** = *Because he had injured his knee, he limped home.*

[40] ***Once mentioned, the name went viral.*** = *After the name was mentioned, it went viral.*

[41] In each case, the elliptical clause has been retrieved, and the meaning is unchanged.

Adverbs *are words or groups of words that qualify verbs, adjectives, other adverbs and also clauses, with respect to time, place, manner, frequency, degree, attitude or perception.* (def-13)

[42] Adverbs answer the questions *where*?, *how*?, *when*? and *how much*? The last one can be extended: *how often*? *how high*? *how surely*? *how much better*? An adverb can even be an answer on its own.

FOUR EXAMPLES

1. ***Maria sings beautifully.*** The adverb ***beautifully*** qualifies the verb ***sings***. *How does Maria sing? Beautifully!* It is an adverb of manner.

2. ***Some people are incredibly naive.*** The adverb ***incredibly*** qualifies the adjective ***naive***. It is an adverb of degree: it tells us how naive.

3. ***We go swimming very early.*** The adverb ***very*** qualifies the adverb ***early***. *Very* is an adverb of degree; *early* is an adverb of time.

4. ***Perhaps they don't believe you.*** The adverb ***perhaps*** qualifies the whole clause ***they don't believe you***. It expresses probability.

Prepositions *are words or groups of words that take nouns or noun phrases as objects and express place, time, direction, cause, manner and so on.* (def-14)

[43] There is no preposition without an object.

THREE EXAMPLES

1. ***I gave the books to them.*** The preposition **to** takes the object ***them***, a pronoun standing in place of a noun, and expresses direction.

2. ***The keys are in my pocket.*** The preposition ***in*** takes the noun phrase ***my pocket*** and expresses place.

3. ***I studied the problem in depth.*** The preposition ***in*** takes the noun ***depth*** and expresses manner.

Noun phrases *are phrases that contain nouns or pronouns and can function as subjects, objects or complements.* (def-15)

dealing with the parts of speech. *Semantics* means meaning.

[29] It follows that the definition of each part of speech must be honoured strictly and without exception.

NOTE 1

The part of speech to which a word belongs in a given sentence is determined solely by the definition whose criteria that word actually satisfies.

Each part of speech has a specific definition. The criteria of the definitions are exclusively semantic, never morphological.

[30] There are ten parts of speech, the same in every language. Some languages, such as Polish and Chinese, have no articles, so they have nine.

THE TEN PARTS OF SPEECH

1. Nouns
2. Articles
3. Pronouns
4. Adjectives
5. Verbs
6. Participles
7. Adverbs
8. Prepositions
9. Conjunctions
10. Interjections

Nouns *are words that name entities.* **(def-6)**

[31] An entity is anything we can name: a person, a thing, a place, an idea. ***Fish***, ***Copenhagen***, ***teacher*** and ***justice*** are all nouns, because each one names an entity.

[32] The definition decides, not the form. In ***Swimming is healthy***, the word ***swimming*** ends like a verb form, but here it names an activity as an entity. It satisfies the definition of a noun, so it is a noun.

Articles *are the words that determine the selectivity of nouns.* **(def-7)**

[33] Compare ***I bought a fish*** with ***I bought the fish***. With ***a***, the fish is not selected: it is any one fish. With ***the***, the fish is selected: it is a particular fish that speaker and listener both know. The noun is the same; the article determines how selective it is.

Pronouns *are words used in place of nouns.* **(def-8)**

[34] In ***Maria bought a fish. She cooked it.***, the word ***she*** stands in place of ***Maria***, and ***it*** stands in place of ***fish***. In our first sentence, ***we*** stands in place of the names of the people who bought the fish.

Adjectives *are words or groups of words that qualify nouns.* **(def-9)**

[35] In ***fresh fish***, the word ***fresh*** qualifies the noun ***fish***, so it is an adjective. In our first sentence, ***this*** qualifies ***morning***, so it is an adjective too.

[36] An adjective can also be a group of words. In ***fish from the market***, the group ***from the market*** qualifies ***fish***. By the definition, it is an adjective.

Verbs *are words that take a subject.* **(def-10)**

Subjects *instantiate the meaning of*

and so on. That is paragrammar.

Thought comes first

[20] Before anything is said or written, it exists as a thought. We do not first find the words and then work out what they mean. We think first, and then we look for the words. The thought is already complete in the mind, with all six concepts in place, before any language gives it form.

[21] Language comes after. It chooses the words, the endings and the word order, and decides how much of the thought is said aloud. By then, grammar has already done its work. Grammar generates the thought; language communicates it. The next two examples show this.

A second example

[22] Take another sentence: ***The children were playing in the garden.***

THE CHILDREN WERE PLAYING IN THE GARDEN.

Parts of speech: ***the*** article, ***children*** noun, ***were*** verb, ***playing*** participle, ***in*** preposition, ***the*** article, ***garden*** noun.

Mood: indicative.

Diathesis: active.

Aspect: progressive. The playing is seen as ongoing, not as one complete act.

Clause: declarative main clause.

Syntax: ***the children*** subject, ***were playing*** verb, ***in the garden*** adverb.

[23] Compared with the first sentence, only the aspect differs. One concept changes, and the thought changes with it: a completed purchase becomes an ongoing game.

What is not said

[24] Someone asks: *When are you leaving?* You answer with one word: ***Tomorrow.***

[25] One word is spoken, yet the listener understands a complete thought: ***[I am leaving]*** *tomorrow*. The words in brackets are not said. They are implied, and grammar supplies them.

[I AM LEAVING] TOMORROW.

Parts of speech: ***[I]*** pronoun, ***[am]*** verb, ***[leaving]*** participle, ***tomorrow*** adverb.

Mood: indicative.

Diathesis: active.

Aspect: progressive.

Clause: declarative main clause.

Syntax: ***[I]*** subject, ***[am leaving]*** verb, ***tomorrow*** adverb.

[26] All six concepts are at work, although only one word was spoken. That is what it means for grammar to generate thought: the thought is complete before a single word is chosen. How much of it we say aloud is paragrammar.

The parts of speech

[27] Before we list the parts of speech, let us define them.

THE PARTS OF SPEECH *are non-semiotic categories of interacting concepts that clarify the semantics of speech.* **(def-5)**

[28] *Non-semiotic* means that the parts of speech have no morphology; that is, we do not take morphology into account when

What grammar is — not what it consists of

Continued from page 1

[5] When we think of something, all six concepts are set in motion. No thought is possible without all six.

[6] The human brain is wired to generate thought in exactly the same way, regardless of language. Grammar is therefore a panhuman trait that unites us all in a very special but overlooked way. Grammar is universal; language is not.

Communication *is the exchange of messages that carry meaning.* **(def-3)**

[7] Every message that carries meaning carries thought, and no thought exists without grammar. All communication is therefore grammatical.

[8] Language is often said to be what gives thoughts a voice, but that is a metaphor, not a definition.

Language *is paragrammatical communication.* **(def-4)**

[9] In other words, language is communication via paragrammar. All communication is grammatical, but only language is both grammatical and paragrammatical. Grammar is what all languages share with all thought; paragrammar is how each language dresses it.

[10] Take one simple sentence: ***We bought fish this morning.*** Say it in Danish, Greek, Spanish or any other language, and the words change, the endings change, the word order may change. But the grammar does not.

Parts of speech

[11] ***We*** is a pronoun, ***bought*** is a verb, ***fish*** is a noun, ***this*** is an adjective and ***morning*** is a noun.

[12] Many words can belong to different parts of speech in different contexts, but in a given context each word belongs to only one. Taken one by one, their equivalents belong to the same parts of speech in every language.

[13] In Greek or Spanish, ***we*** can be stated (εμείς, *nosotros/as*) or left to the verb ending. Either way, the pronoun is there. Only its marking differs, and that is paragrammar.

Mood

[14] The sentence states a fact. It is in the indicative mood, in all languages.

Diathesis

[15] The subject performs the action: we did the buying. The sentence is active, in all languages.

Aspect

[16] The buying is seen as one complete act. The aspect is synoptic, in all languages.

Clause

[17] It is a declarative main clause, in all languages.

Syntax

[18] ***We*** is the subject, ***bought*** is the verb, ***fish*** is the direct object and ***this morning*** is the adverb, in all languages.

[19] Six concepts, and not one of them changes across languages. What varies *from language to language* is how each language marks them: its endings, its word order, its spelling, its pronunciation

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HORISTICS

The Revealing Power Of Definitions

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What grammar is — not what it consists of

Grammar *is the generation of thought.*
(def-1)

[1] In other words, it is grammar that generates thoughts.

[2] That sounds simple, but it says what grammar is, not what it consists of. What pass for definitions of grammar are really descriptions, not definitions.

Thoughts *are mental, composite, simulated representations of occurrences.*
(def-2)

[3] Grammar generates thoughts through six fundamental concepts: parts of speech, moods, diatheses, aspects, clauses and syntax. Everything else (morphology, vocabulary, punctuation, pronunciation and so on) is paragrammar.

[4] These concepts are not new. Grammar as a discipline was founded by the Greeks: by Socrates (470–399 Before Year 1, BY1) in Plato's *Cratylus*, who examines the correctness of names and distinguishes nouns (ὀνόματα) from verbs (ῥήματα); by Dionysius Thrax (c. 170–90 BY1), whose *Art of Grammar* set out the eight parts of speech; and by Apollonius Dyscolus (2nd century After Year 1, AY1), who founded the study of syntax.

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The Law vs The Penalty For Breaking The Law

Enforcing the penalty for breaking the law is not the law itself.

[53] What is justice? Let us define it:

Justice *is the prevention of crime.*

[54] Once a crime has been committed, no justice can be done, because justice is preventing crime. What follows — arrest, trial, imprisonment — has to do with the penalty for breaking the law, which is not justice. So what is called law enforcement is really penalty enforcement.

[55] This shows a great deal about the revealing power of definitions, and what it reveals is central to a myriad of misconceptions that derail millions of lives.

[56] Consider the phrase we hear on the news every week: the criminal was "brought to justice." He was not. He was brought to penalty. The justice that could have been done was the prevention of his crime, and that moment passed before the crime took place. What remains after the fact is a consequence, not a remedy.

[57] Consider the victim. We tell the victim that justice will be done, that the verdict will bring justice. But the harm has already happened, and no sentence undoes it. The victim is promised one thing and

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